

2. IDEATION PHASE

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Date	01 October 2026
Team ID	SWTID-2026-4302
Project Name	Import Data using Transform Maps (Spreadsheet)
Team Members	Prasanna K, Yousuf Riyas S, Ratnakar K S, Mohammed Thoufiq I

2.1 Problem Statement

A customer problem statement helps the team see the problem from the user's point of view. Three problem statements were identified for this project (template: Customer Problem Statement, Miro).

Problem Statement Table

PS	I am (customer)	I'm trying to	But	Because	Which makes me feel
PS-1	A ServiceNow administrator	Load bulk employee data (Employee ID, Name, Email, Department, Location) received as an Excel spreadsheet	Entering the records one by one is slow and error-prone	The data arrives in Excel and has no direct route into the Employee table without an import process	Frustrated and worried about accuracy
PS-2	An HR data owner who re-sends updated employee sheets	Keep employee records current when the same data is imported more than once	Every import creates duplicate employee records	Nothing identifies an existing employee by a unique key such as Employee ID (no coalesce)	Uncertain and unable to trust the data
PS-3	An HR user	See how employees are distributed by department and location	I have to read raw table rows to find out	There are no reports or dashboard on the employee data	Uninformed and slowed down

Problem statement (summary)

Employee data is held in spreadsheets outside ServiceNow. Without a controlled import process the data is typed in manually, re-imports create duplicates, and HR cannot easily see the result. The project solves this with Import Sets, Transform Maps, Coalesce, Reports and a Dashboard.

2.2 Empathy Map Canvas

An empathy map captures what a user says, thinks, does and feels, together with their pains and gains. It helps the team understand the real problem and the person who experiences it before designing the solution (template: Empathy Map Canvas, Mural / Gray, Dave Gray).

User / Persona: ServiceNow administrator working with an HR data owner. **Goal:** load employee data from a spreadsheet accurately, without duplicates, and see it summarised. **Scenario:** Employee data import into ServiceNow.

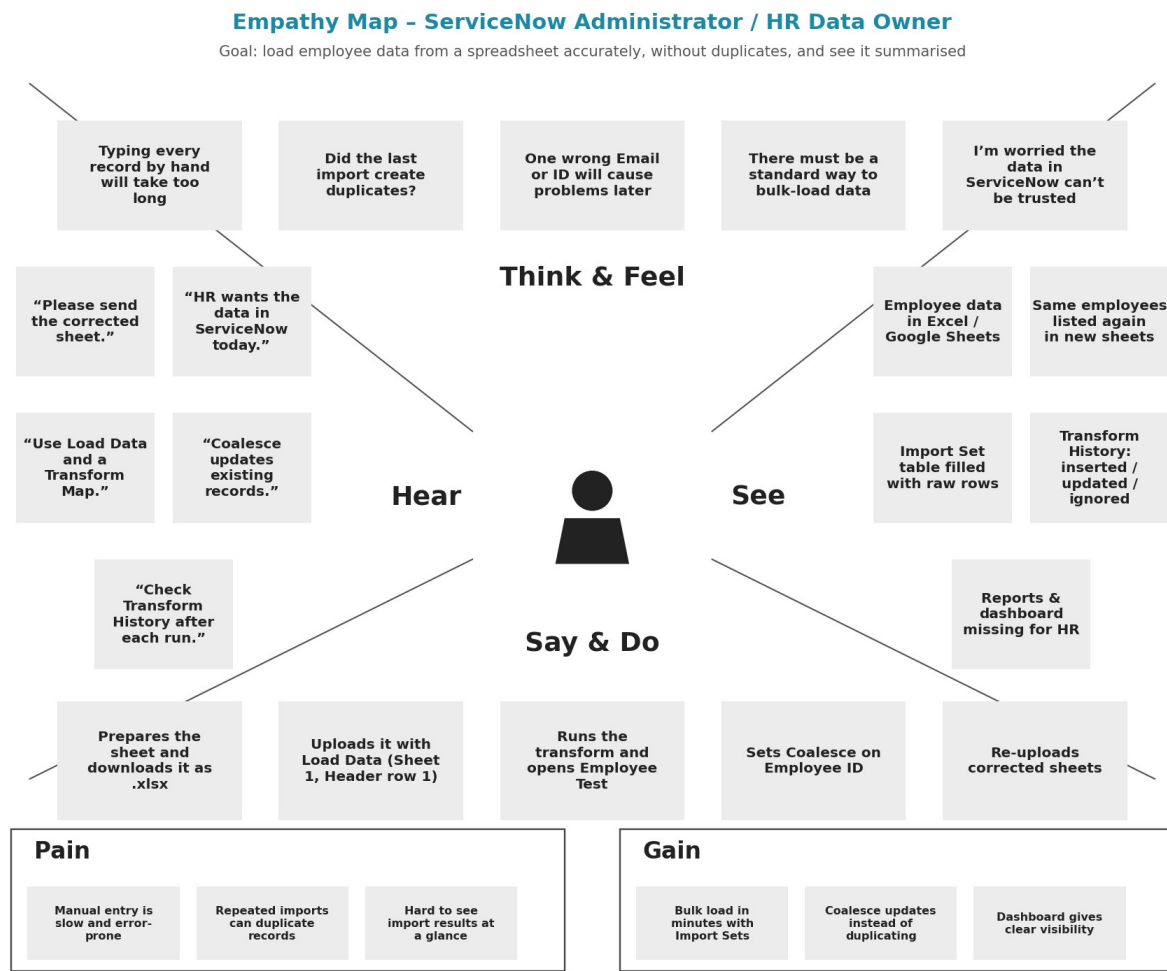


Figure 2.1 – Empathy map canvas: ServiceNow administrator / HR data owner (Think & Feel, Hear, See, Say & Do, Pain, Gain)

Insight: the user's biggest fear is losing trust in the data. The solution therefore focuses on repeatable imports (Coalesce) and visible results (Transform History, dashboard).

2.3 Brainstorming

Brainstorming gives every team member a free and open environment to contribute ideas; volume is prioritised over value at first, and ideas are then grouped and ranked (template: Brainstorm & Idea Prioritization, Mural).

Step 1 – Team gathering, collaboration and problem selection

1 Team gathering & problem statement

Define who participates, set the goal and frame the problem as a “How might we” statement.

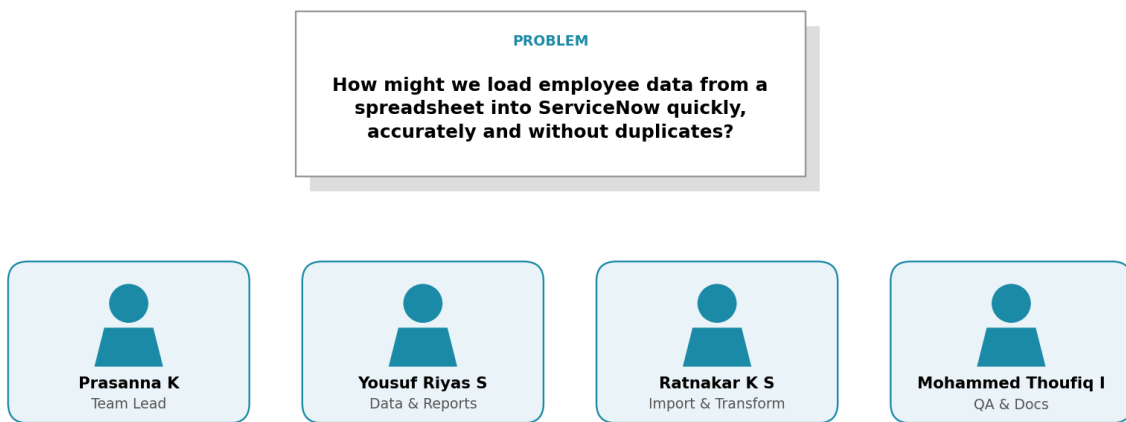


Figure 2.2 – Team gathering and the “How might we” problem statement

Team members	Prasanna K (Team Lead), Yousuf Riyas S, Ratnakar K S, Mohammed Thoufiq I
Brainstorm topic	How can employee data received as a spreadsheet be loaded into ServiceNow quickly, accurately and without duplicates?
Selected problem statements	PS-1 (bulk import from a spreadsheet) and PS-2 (repeated imports create duplicates); PS-3 (reporting) as an extension

Step 2 – Brainstorm and idea listing

Each team member wrote down ideas on sticky notes without judging them (volume over value). The thirteen core ideas below came out of this round.

2 Brainstorm

Each team member writes down any idea that addresses the problem statement (10 minutes).

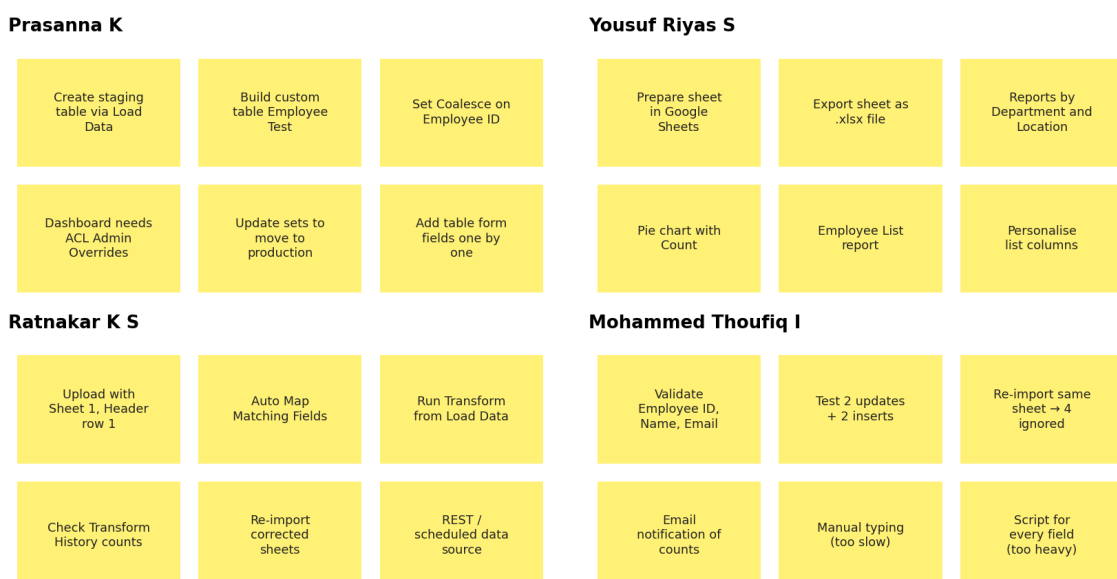


Figure 2.3 – Idea listing: sticky notes written by each team member

Step 3 – Group ideas

Similar notes were clustered and each cluster was given a label: getting data in, mapping the data, data quality and insight.

3 Group ideas

Similar ideas are clustered and each cluster gets a sentence-like label (20 minutes).

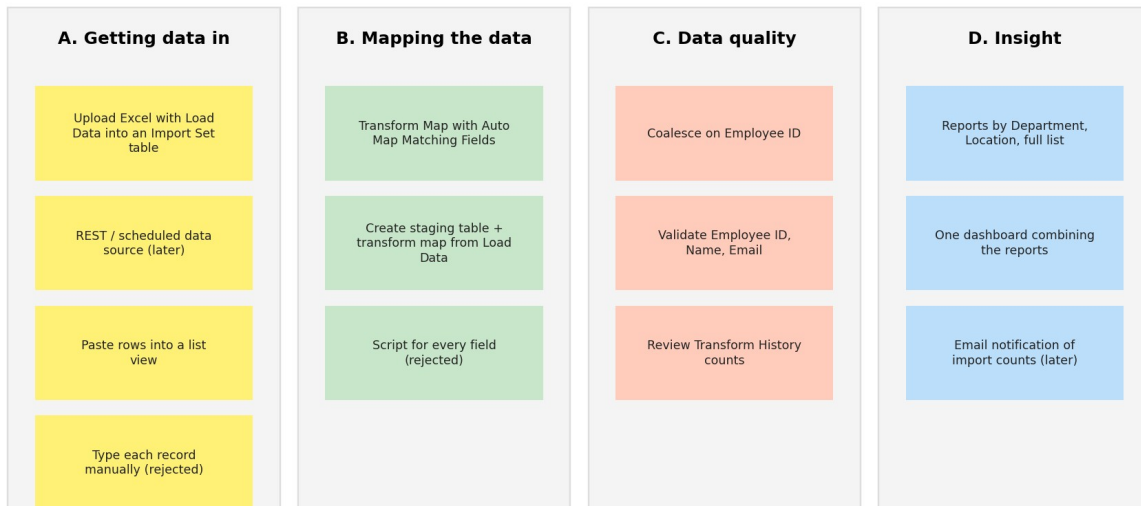


Figure 2.4 – Grouped ideas

Step 4 – Idea prioritisation

4 Idea prioritisation

Ideas are placed by effort (low → high) and impact (low → high); vote and pick what to do first.

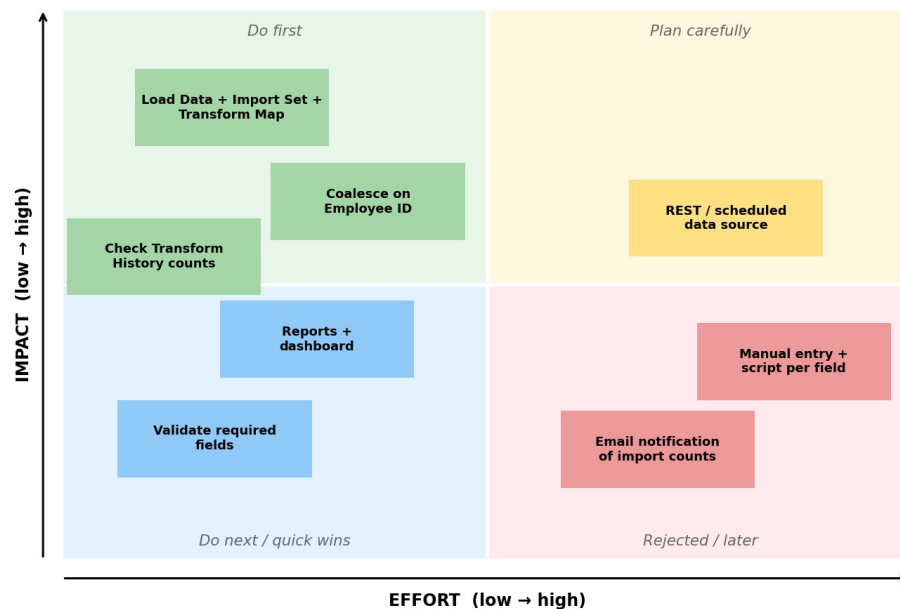


Figure 2.5 – Impact vs effort matrix used to prioritise ideas

Idea	Impact	Effort	Priority / Decision
2 + 5 + 7 Load Data, Import Set table and Transform Map (no code)	High	Low	Do first (Milestones 1 and 2)

Idea	Impact	Effort	Priority / Decision
8 Coalesce on Employee ID	High	Low	Do first (Milestone 3)
10 Check Transform History counts	Medium	Low	Do first (Milestone 3)
11 + 12 Reports and dashboard	Medium	Medium	Do next (Reports & Dashboard)
9 Validation of required fields	Medium	Medium	Do next / test in UAT
3 REST / scheduled data source	Medium	High	Later (Future Scope)
13 Email notification of import counts	Low	Medium	Later (Future Scope)
1 Manual entry, 6 scripts for every field	Low	High	Rejected

Reference: <https://miro.com/templates/customer-problem-statement/> | <https://www.mural.co/templates/empathy-map-canvas> | <https://www.mural.co/templates/brainstorm-and-idea-prioritization>